ERA 10

Emancipation & Total War

1862 – 1865

Emancipation · the turning points · Union victory

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the Civil War become a war to end slavery—and how did the Union win it?

KEY TERMS

Emancipation Proclamation · the 54th Massachusetts · Gettysburg · Gettysburg Address · Appomattox

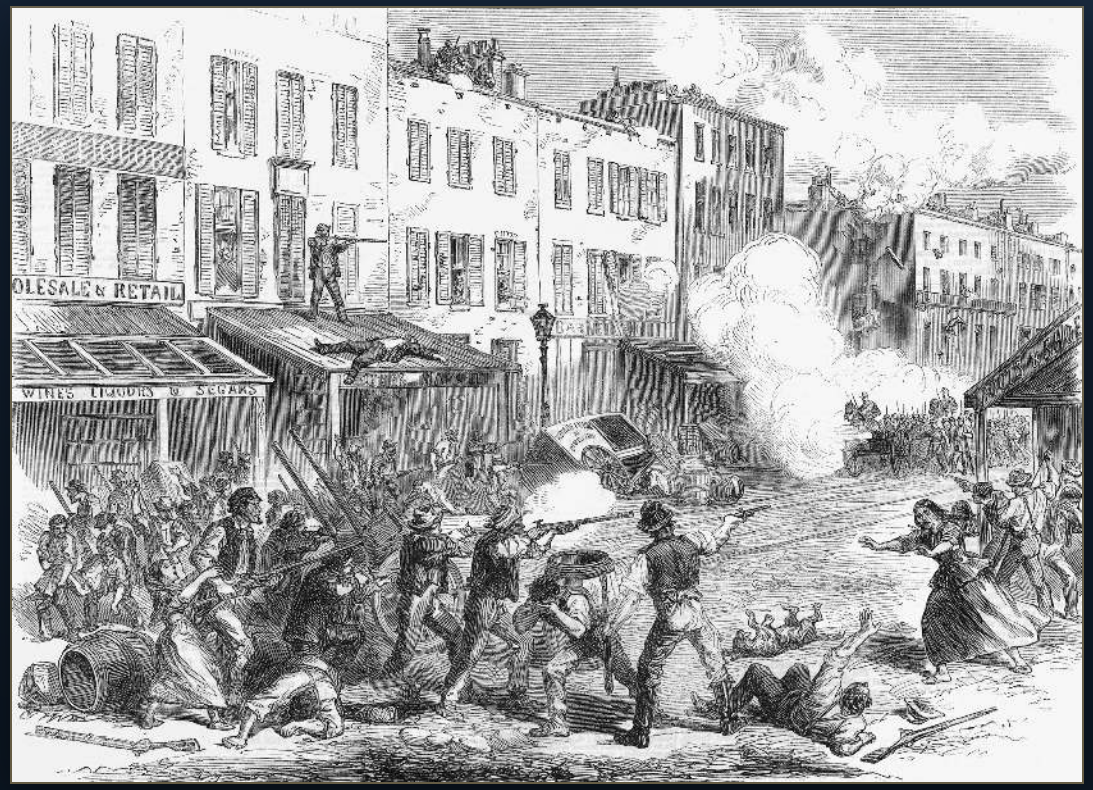
ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 5.9 · AMSCO Ch. 5.9

MOBILIZING A WHOLE SOCIETY

Total War

Mobilizing for War



- Both sides resorted to a **draft** (**conscription**) to fill the ranks.
- The draft was deeply unpopular—the poor felt it fell on them.
- In the 1863 **New York City Draft Riots**, mobs attacked Black residents.

SECTION

A War for Freedom

Why Lincoln Changed the War's Aim

1861

Preserve the Union

Lincoln's only goal is to hold the nation together.

→

SEPT 1862

Antietam

A Union victory gives Lincoln the moment to act.

→

JAN 1863

Emancipation

Ending slavery becomes an official Union war aim.

→

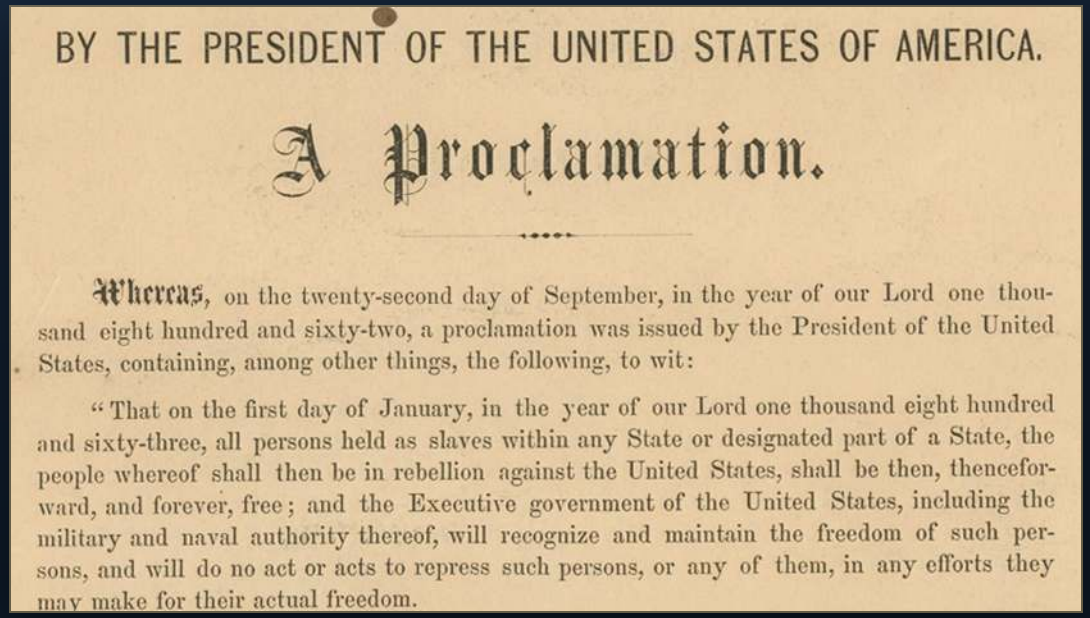
RESULT

A New Cause

The fight becomes one for 'a new birth of freedom.'

The Emancipation Proclamation, 1863

- **Lincoln** issued it after the Battle of **Antietam**.
- It declared enslaved people in rebel states 'forever free.'
- It freed few immediately—but reframed the war as a fight against slavery.



BY THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA.

A Proclamation.

Whereas, on the twenty-second day of September, in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and sixty-two, a proclamation was issued by the President of the United States, containing, among other things, the following, to wit:

"That on the first day of January, in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and sixty-three, all persons held as slaves within any State or designated part of a State, the people whereof shall then be in rebellion against the United States, shall be then, thenceforward, and forever, free; and the Executive government of the United States, including the military and naval authority thereof, will recognize and maintain the freedom of such persons, and will do no act or acts to repress such persons, or any of them, in any efforts they may make for their actual freedom.

Black Soldiers Fight for Freedom



- The Proclamation let Black men enlist—like the famed **54th Massachusetts**.
- By war's end, one in eight Union soldiers was Black.
- They fought bravely despite unequal pay and fierce discrimination.

SECTION

The Turning Point: 1863

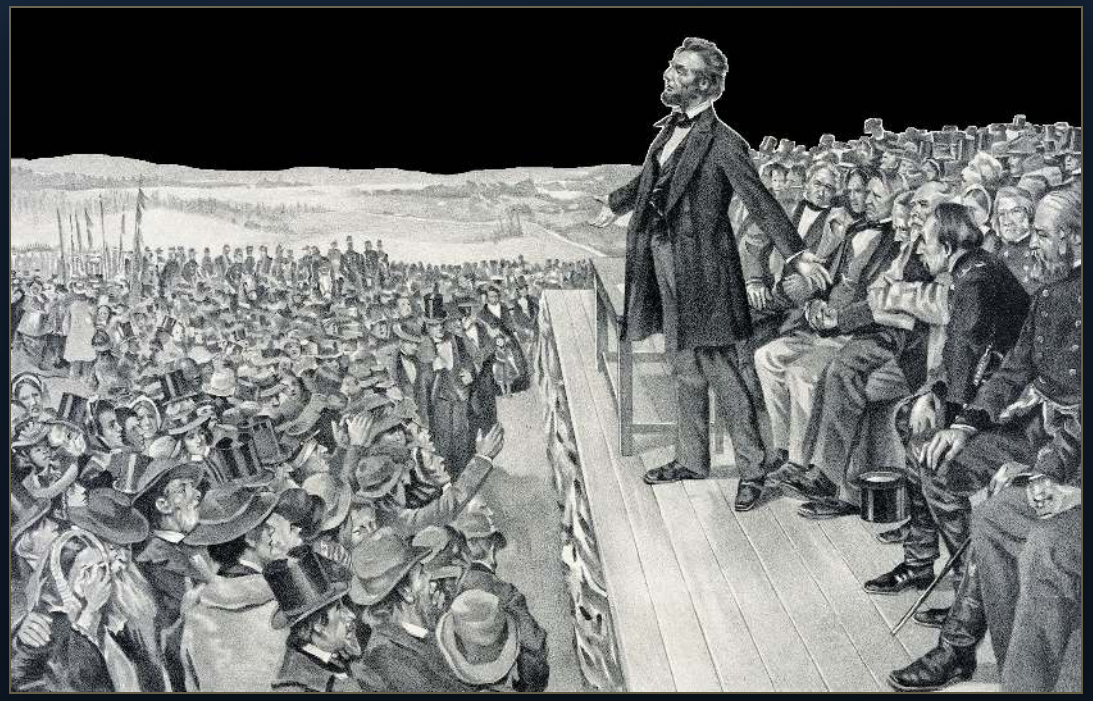
Gettysburg & Vicksburg



- In July 1863, the Union repelled Lee's invasion at **Gettysburg**.
- The same week, **Vicksburg** fell—splitting the Confederacy at the Mississippi.
- Together they marked the war's decisive turning point.

The Gettysburg Address

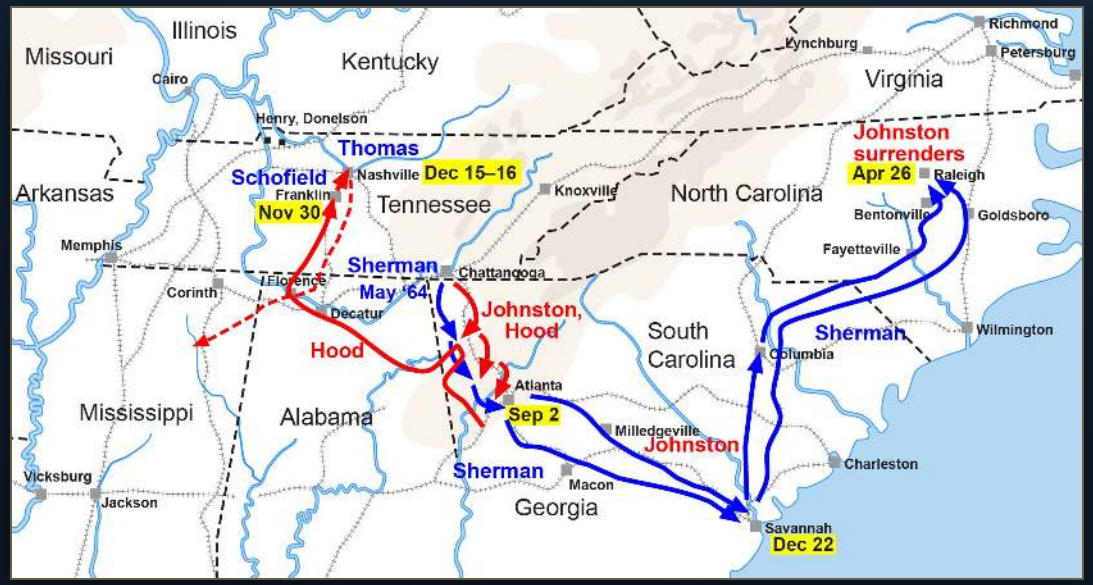
- **Lincoln** spoke at the dedication of the **Gettysburg** cemetery.
- In just a few minutes, he redefined the war's purpose.
- He called for 'a **new birth of freedom**' and government 'of, by, and for the people.'



SECTION

Victory & Its Cost

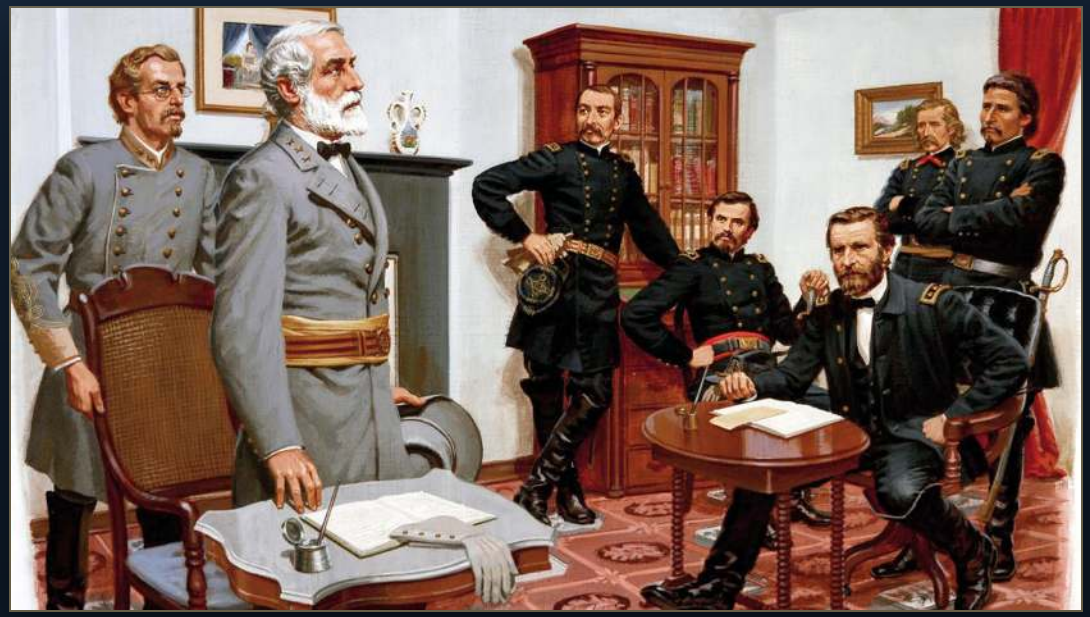
Total War



- General Sherman's **March to the Sea** cut a path of destruction through Georgia.
- The Union waged **total war**—targeting the South's economy and will to fight.
- It was a brutal preview of modern warfare.

Appomattox, 1865

- **Robert E. Lee** surrendered to **Ulysses S. Grant** at **Appomattox** in April 1865.
- The war claimed roughly 750,000 lives.
- The **13th Amendment** soon abolished slavery forever.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

Emancipation & Total War

1. The **Emancipation Proclamation** (1863) transformed the war into a fight to end slavery—and opened the ranks to **Black soldiers**.

2. **Gettysburg and Vicksburg** turned the tide, and the **Gettysburg Address** gave the war a higher purpose.

3. **Total war** broke the South; Lee's surrender at **Appomattox** ended the war, and the **13th Amendment** abolished slavery.

DISCUSS & APPLY

Emancipation & Total War

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

Explain how and why the Union's war aim shifted from **preserving the Union** to **ending slavery**.

CAUSATION

Explain why **Gettysburg and Vicksburg** (July 1863) are seen as the turning point of the war.

ARGUMENTATION

The Gettysburg Address promised a **'new birth of freedom.'** Using today's evidence, how fully did the war deliver it?

Up next — **Lesson 25: Reconstruction** (rebuilding a divided nation)